according to the act, he must report to the justices at each quarter-sessions, a state of the health of the prisoners under his care.[1]

At Newgate there are commonly about two hundred prisoners. Here the danger to them, and to the city from them, is great. To this capital prison in the metropolis, the magistrates would, in my opinion, do well to appoint a physician, a surgeon, and apothecary. One of the two latter to visit each ward in the prison every day. The two compters are near enough to be taken care of by the same gentlemen; and they need to be visited as constantly. This attention would, in all probability, prevent the spread of any infectious disease in those gaols; and silence county gaolers, who, when their prisons are infected, tell you (as I have often heard them), "The distemper was brought from Newgate, by prisoners removed from thence by habeas corpus."

No prisoner should be subject to any demand of fees. The gaoler should have a salary in lieu of them: and so should the turnkeys; their wages should not be included in the gaoler's salary: and not only their pay, but the number of them necessary for each prison, should be determined by the magistrates. Neither of those articles should be left to the interested appointment of a gaoler. If fees be not abolished, I am sure they should be reduced; and so should the chamber-rents for master-side debtors. In this matter (of the chambers) another regulation is also needful; that is, no middle-sized room should have more beds than two. The bedding and other furniture should be specified as to articles and value.

For common-side debtors there should be a ward entirely free: they should not be subject to any demand of rent; as in many prisons they are. These prisoners should either be alimented by their creditors without expense and delay; or have from the county the same allowance of every kind as felons: food, bedding, and medicine.

In order to cleanliness; than which scarce anything in the whole economy of a gaol is of more importance, the ceiling and walls of every ward and room should be well scraped; and then washed with the best stone-lime taken hot from the kiln, and slaked in boiling water and size, and used during the strong

[1] In some foreign countries an officer of rank is obliged frequently to visit the prisons, with a surgeon. He has a list of the prisoners, and sees each of them, and makes a report to the regency of their health, and the care that is taken of them.

effervescence;[1] at least twice a year; just after the Lent and summer assize. Each ward and room should be swept, and washed every day, by the respective inhabitants; and sometimes with hot vinegar. Idle gaolers affect to excuse their negligence in this respect, by pretending that daily washing would make the rooms damp, and endanger the health of prisoners. This is mere pretence. I know the effect is directly contrary. There is not in England a prison more healthy, considering the number of prisoners, than Tothill-fields bridewell; where the rooms are washed every day. The prisoners do the work by turns: and the healthiness of the prison is a demonstration, that no inconvenience, but great benefit is the consequence.[2] In Newgate, the prisoner who sweeps the ward has a double allowance of bread. Every prisoner should be obliged to wash his hands and face before he comes for his daily allowance; and to keep himself as neat as circumstances will admit. I have said before, there should be plenty of water in a prison; and need not add now, that prisoners should constantly have free and easy access to it. Nothing can be more unreasonable than the pretences used among us to justify inattention on this subject. All unprejudiced persons must acknowledge the absolute necessity of fresh air and cleanliness to preserve and promote health.

Every prisoner who comes to gaol dirty, should be washed in the cold or warm bath; and his clothes should be put into the oven, in a sack on a pair of iron dogs. He should be provided with coarse washing clothes to wear while his own are thus purifying: clothes should be kept ready in the gaol for this purpose.[3] Each prisoner should have a clean shirt twice a week. There should be in each ward a towel on a roller clean every day. Pails, mops, brooms, soap, vinegar, and fuel,

[1] This is called lime-white, although whiting is not an ingredient in it. Nothing is more effectual to destroy vermin, purify the air, and prevent infection. Whitewashing is not only proper for cleanliness, but attempts to escape are more easily discovered in white than in dirty walls.

[2] From the general practice of foreigners in building their prisons near the water, it seems, that they had no apprehension of bad consequences arising from such a situation; but they were convinced of the necessity of cleanliness, and of the bad effects of offensive drains.

[3] It would be better if criminals were to wear a kind of prison uniform during the whole of their confinement, as I have seen practised at many foreign prisons. Among other good effects, this would make them more liable to be discovered on escaping. On the other hand, they should be tried in their own clothes, for the obvious reason that they may be more easily recognised by the witnesses.